

Children are growing up online.

Are we preparing them for it?

The internet has solved the problem of access. The challenge now is judgment — knowing what to trust, and what to ignore. For India's 8–14 year-olds, building that judgment has become one of the most urgent priorities for schools and families alike.

"We would never expect a child to drive on the highway without first learning the rules. Yet every day we expect them to navigate the information highway with almost no preparation."

— Pankaj Rai, Founder, COMPUDON Junior

85.5%

of Indian households now own a smartphone — routine digital access begins early.

47%

of Indian children spend 3–6 hours online daily; 10% more spend over six.

70%

of fake news in India passes through a "verified" handle before it spreads.

32%

year-on-year rise in cybercrimes against children (NCRB, 2021–22).

Sources: NITI Aayog, *Online Safety for Children* (2025); LocalCircles; NCRB; NewsChecker.

THE SHIFT

The new skills gap is about judgment, not access

For most Indian children, access is no longer the problem. What remains is harder: deciding what to trust, protecting their privacy, resisting manipulation, and using AI thoughtfully — skills currently learned through trial, error, and peer influence, rather than deliberate teaching.

A FRAMEWORK FOR DIGITAL READINESS

Six capabilities, two cross-cutting foundations

01

Manage harmful interactions

Recognise bullying, harassment and unsafe contact, and know when and how to seek help.

02

Resist manipulation & deception

Identify scams, pressure tactics and deceptive content designed to influence behaviour.

03

Protect privacy & identity

Safeguard personal information and understand the footprint each action leaves.

04

Think critically & create

Make informed, independent decisions in high-attention digital environments.

05

Read media with discernment

Distinguish reliable information from misinformation and spot manipulation tactics.

06

Use AI effectively

Use AI as a learning partner — asking good questions, checking answers, thinking independently.

● **Digital Rights & Responsibilities** — safety, privacy and dignity online, and the responsibilities that come with them.

● **Digital Law, Reporting & Help-seeking** — knowing how to get help: a trusted adult, school channels, and India's 1930 helpline.

— TWO AGE-APPROPRIATE TRACKS

One championship, two stages

An 8-year-old and a 13-year-old are not the same child. Each stage runs its own curriculum, exam and awards, so students compete only against peers at the same stage.

Explorers

Ages 8–10 · Grades 3–5

WHERE THEY ARE

Concrete thinkers who follow adult-set rules; just beginning to go online, with little vocabulary to describe what they encounter.

WHAT THEY NEED

Safe habits and the reflex to **pause and tell** a trusted adult — not yet independent judgment.

Navigators

Ages 11–14 · Grades 6+

WHERE THEY ARE

Abstract reasoning is emerging and peer opinion often outweighs adult authority; active on social media and AI tools.

WHAT THEY NEED

The ability to evaluate under pressure — judge a source, resist persuasion, protect identity. **Pause and think.**

— NATIONALLY ALIGNED

Anchored in India's own policy and education frameworks

✓ NEP 2020

✓ NCF 2023

✓ CBSE Cyber Safety

✓ NCERT

✓ DPDP Act 2023

✓ NITI Aayog

Every COMPUDON Junior capability maps directly to at least one of these national frameworks — the model is synthesised from India's own policy, not imported wholesale from elsewhere.

1930 If something goes wrong: cybercrime.gov.in · I4C · NCPCR — and always a trusted adult at home or school.

"In India, COMPUDON Junior has taken remarkable initiatives to empower children, help them stay safe online, and become responsible digital citizens."

Dr. Vinnie Jauhari
Senior Education Industry Advisor, Microsoft

"He used to forward everything without thinking. Now he stops and asks, 'Is this real? Who made this?'"

Parent of a Grade 6 student
Bengaluru

— FROM PRINCIPLE TO PRACTICE

A whole-school model that asks little of your timetable

Students

Practise the skills and earn recognition.

Teachers

Facilitate — no lesson planning, no added workload.

Parents

See the change at home, stay involved.

School

Anchors readiness as a shared value.

Runs with minimal teacher involvement; student data handling aligns with the DPDP Act, 2023.

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— **Pankaj Rai, Founder, COMPUDON Junior**

Bring COMPUDON Junior to your school.

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Season VII · Ages 8–14 · Now enrolling